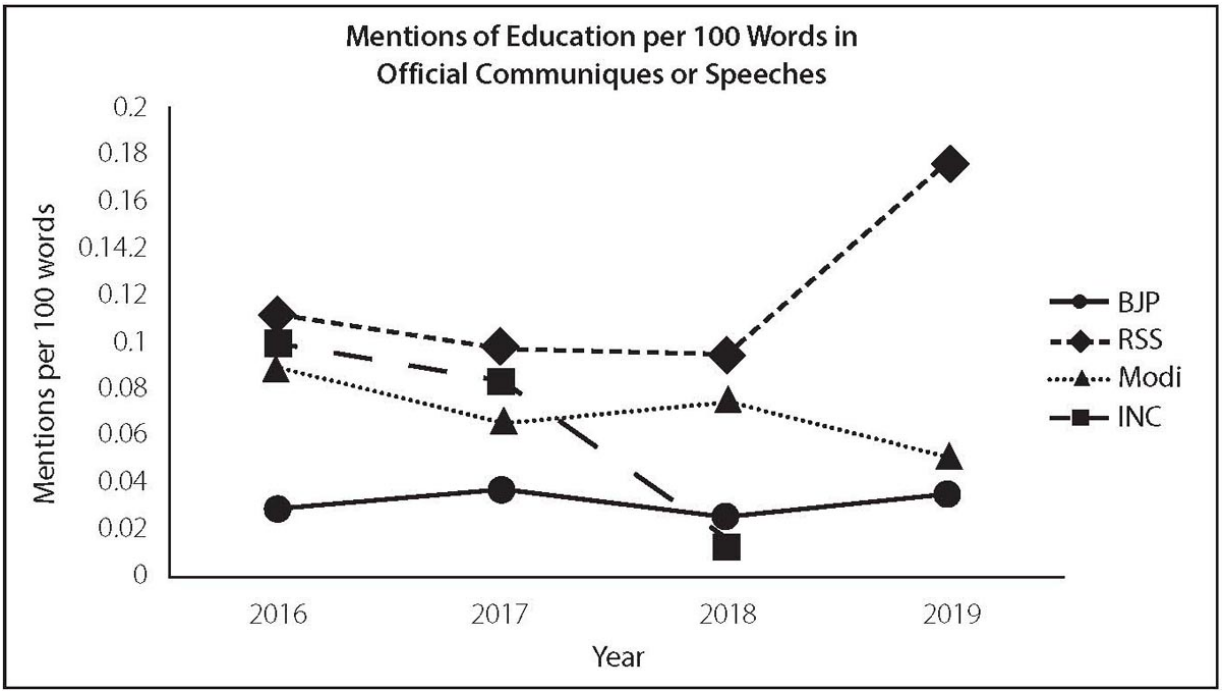


Source: Narad Index, Nalin Mehta and Rishabh Srivastava; for more details, see Appendix 4

Thus, when the Modi government adopted the NEP in July 2020 (the first such policy after 1986),[80] *Organiser* welcomed it with a gushing cover story headlined 'Foundation for Freedom'. In a signed editorial, its editor, Prafulla Ketkar, hailed the structural changes that the NEP proposed as a 'major breakthrough'. Tellingly, he framed the new language policies as a tool of decolonisation, linking them to the legacy of the freedom movement leader (and Hindu traditionalist) Lokmanya Tilak, who had declared that the 'classification of letter and sounds on which we have bestowed so much labour in India and which we find perfected in the works of Panini is not to be found in any other language in the world'. For the RSS, criticism of the NEP was akin to the opposition Tilak faced in colonial India. Just as he was 'mocked' for trying to bring a 'national character to education', argued *Organiser*, 'people with the same colonised mindset' were now criticising NEP 2020.[81] Similarly, Sangh-affiliated outfits like the Shiksha Sanskriti Utthan Nyas (SSUN) saw the NEP as a 'resurgence of Bharatiyata'.[82] They also interpreted it as a negation of the 'deep shadow of Marxist policy makers' who had been influenced by what one writer called the 'socialist and secular